S-Adenosyl methionine thus formed acts as a methyl group donor and is involved in the synthesis of epinephrine, creatine and thymine.

4.2. UREA CYCLE

Toxicity of Ammonia

The ammonia formed by trans-deamination and from other sources like bacteria in the gut are transported to the liver and converted to urea. Under physiological conditions, the level of ammonia in the blood is kept under control stringently as the central nervous system is highly susceptible to ammonia intoxication. The major symptoms of ammonia intoxication include slurred speech, tremor, blurred vision, coma and finally death. Ammonia toxicity is because it reacts with α-ketoglutarate to form glutamate, thus depleting the levels of α-ketoglutarate and impairing the function of TCA cycle in neurons.

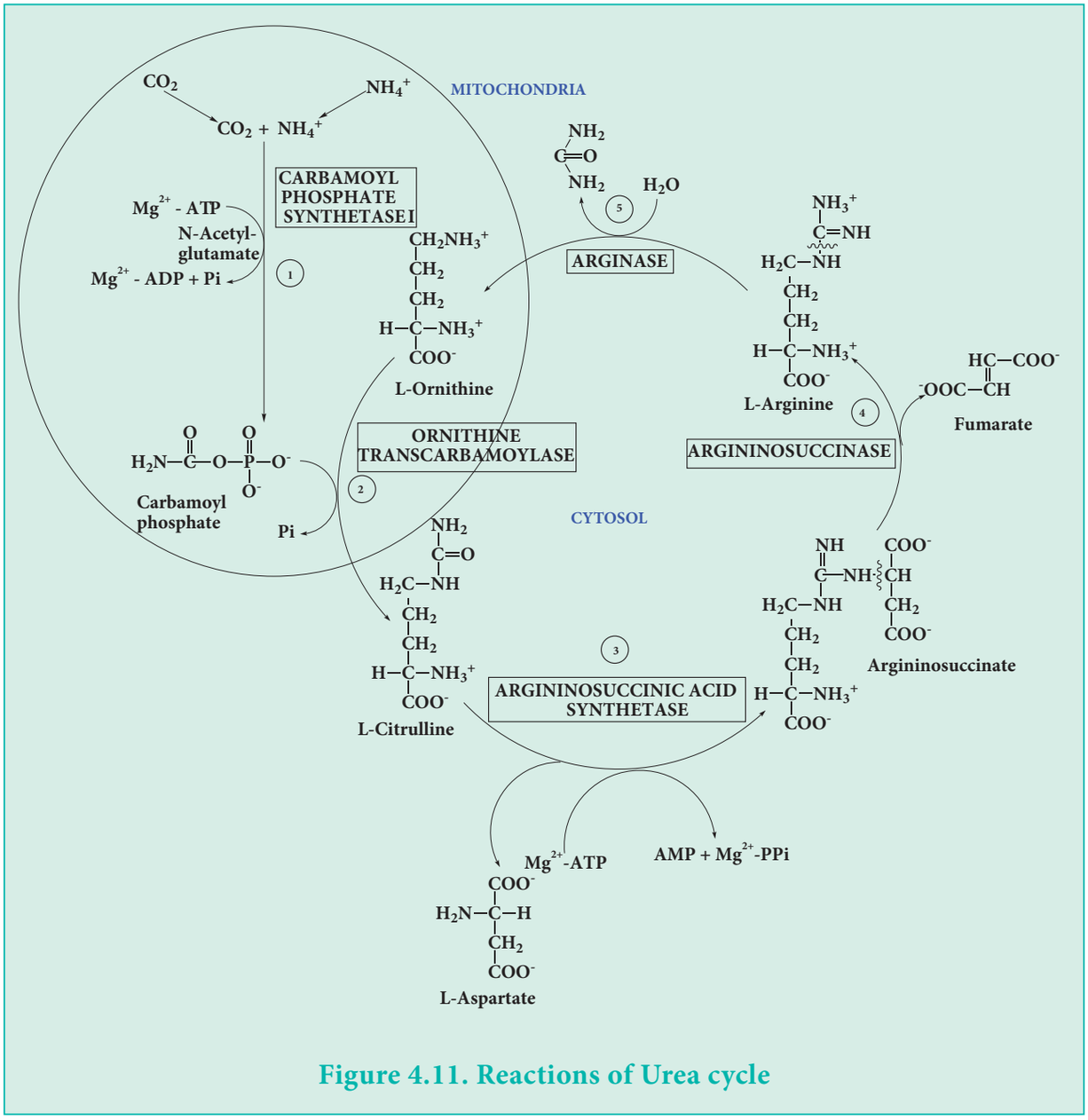

Figure 4.11. Reactions of Urea cycle

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